Sir Theodore Gregory, Economic Adviser to the Government of India, was designated to attend this meeting on behalf of India. However, it was later decided that Raisman, and Deshmukh should also go to Atlantic City with a view to ensuring that the questions in which India was particularly interested were included in the draft agenda. The Indian delegates secured the inclusion of two amendments to the purposes of the Fund, so as 1) 'to assist in the fuller utilization of the resources of economically underdeveloped countries' and 2) 'to promote and facilitate the settlement of abnormal indebtedness arising out of the war'.[6]

On the night of June 30, the delegates boarded the special train that would take them to Bretton Woods, New Hampshire, described as 'a wide basin of woods and meadows, surrounded by low mountains, set in the White Mountain National Forest.'[7] The delegates booked into Mount Washington Hotel which was in no condition to receive its guests. The management had only a month to prepare for the Conference and painters and cleaners were still on the job when the guests arrived. Rooms were mixed up, offices had to be hastily improvised, and there was a 'general feeling of ineffective goodwill.'[8] Bretton Woods, the postal address of the hotel was only a stop on the railway. It had no store, not even a main street, with the hotel being self-sufficient to meet all needs. The beauty of the surroundings was in striking contrast to the confusion created by the arrival of more than 700 people from forty-four countries, their multi-lingual chatter prompting the trains that brought them to be dubbed 'the Tower of Babel on wheels.'[9] They came with different ideas and divergent interests. It is said that the hotel was crawling with spies.

White had planned two main commissions, Commission I on the Fund which he would chair, and Commission II on the Bank with Keynes at its head. There was also a third commission, Commission III which was to concern itself with 'Other Means of International Financial Cooperation' which Skidelsky calls a 'residual rag-bag'.[10] Commission I was to consider the draft prepared in Atlantic City and Commission II would draft the constitution of the Bank. Commission I was divided into four committees: Committee 1—Purposes, Policies, and Quotas of the Fund; Committee 2—Operations of the Fund; Committee 3—Organization and Management; and Committee 4—Form and Status of the Fund. White was determined to maintain control while giving the impression of participation. Decisions